



ANAPHORA

Repeating a word or phrase at the start of successive lines

1 What is it?

Anaphora (uh-NAF-uh-ruh)

Anaphora is the repetition of a word or phrase at the beginning of successive clauses or sentences, used to build rhythm and emphasise an idea.

same phrase + repeated at the start + of each line

2 See it in action

Speech

"**We shall fight** on the beaches, **we shall fight** on the landing grounds..."

Poetry

"**I have** a dream that... **I have** a dream that..."

Everyday

"**Every day** she trained. **Every day** she failed. **Every day** she tried again."

Persuasion

"**Never** give in. **Never** give in. **Never, never, never.**"



Think about...

Try writing three sentences in a row that all start with the same phrase — notice how the rhythm builds as you go.

3 More to know

Protest chant

"**No justice**, no peace. **No justice**, no peace."

Storytelling

"**Once upon a time...** **once upon a time**, everything changed."

FUN FACT

Winston Churchill's 1940 speech used anaphora with "we shall fight" repeated seven times in a row — one of the most famous examples of the technique in English political history.

4 Why it's used

Anaphora helps: build a strong, driving rhythm and hammer a single idea into the reader's or listener's memory through sheer repetition.

Anaphora is one specific type of repetition — the key feature is that it always happens at the beginning of each clause or sentence, not anywhere else.



Look here!

Anaphora works best when read aloud — the repetition creates a rhythm that's often more powerful spoken than written.

5 Don't mix it up

ANAPHORA

Anaphora repeats a phrase at the **START** of successive lines:
"We shall fight... we shall fight..."

REPETITION (GENERAL)

Repetition is the broader category — repeating a word or idea anywhere for effect, not necessarily at the start of each line.

⚠ Watch out!

Anaphora needs to happen across at least two or three consecutive lines or sentences to really land — a single repeated word in one sentence isn't usually described as anaphora.

6 Quick recap

Repeats phrase at the start

Builds rhythm and emphasis

Common in speeches



Good spot!

Look for anaphora specifically at the **START** of sentences or clauses — that's what separates it from repetition in general.